

Northfield Analytics Inc.

IT Support Guide — Version 3.2

1. Overview

This guide covers common IT procedures for employees of Northfield Analytics Inc., including password resets, VPN setup, hardware requests, the ticketing system, and security guidelines. For issues not covered here, contact the IT Service Desk at itsupport@northfieldanalytics.example or open a ticket through the internal helpdesk portal. The IT Service Desk operates Monday through Friday, 8:00 AM to 7:00 PM, with on-call emergency support available for critical outages.

2. Password and Account Management

2.1 Resetting Your Password

To reset a forgotten password, visit the self-service portal at account.northfieldanalytics.example and click 'Forgot Password'. You will receive a one-time verification code by SMS to the mobile number on file. Passwords must be at least 12 characters and include at least one uppercase letter, one number, and one special character. Passwords expire every 90 days and cannot reuse any of the previous 5 passwords.

2.2 Multi-Factor Authentication

All employees are required to enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) on their company accounts using the Northfield Authenticator app. If you lose access to your MFA device, contact the IT Service Desk immediately to have it temporarily disabled while you re-enroll a new device; this requires manager confirmation for security purposes.

2.3 Locked Accounts

Accounts are automatically locked after 5 failed login attempts within 15 minutes. Locked accounts unlock automatically after 30 minutes, or employees can call the IT Service Desk for an immediate unlock after verifying their identity.

3. VPN and Remote Access

Employees connecting from outside the office network must use the Northfield VPN client, available for download from the software portal. To set up the VPN for the first time, install the client, sign in with your company credentials, and select the 'US-East' or 'EU-West' gateway depending on your location. The VPN session times out after 8 hours of inactivity and must be reconnected. Split tunneling is disabled by default for security reasons; all traffic is routed through the corporate network while connected.

If the VPN fails to connect, first confirm your internet connection is stable, then restart the VPN client. Persistent connection failures should be reported as a ticket with category 'Network > VPN' so the networking team can review firewall logs.

4. Hardware Requests and Repairs

New hardware requests, such as a replacement laptop, second monitor, or peripherals, should be submitted through the IT Service Desk portal under category 'Hardware > New Request'. Standard requests are fulfilled within 10 business days; urgent requests due to a failed device can be marked 'High Priority' and are typically resolved within 2 business days, subject to stock availability. Loaner laptops are available at the front desk of each office for employees whose device is being repaired.

Hardware repairs are handled by the on-site IT team at the New York and London offices; remote employees should ship devices to the nearest regional depot using the prepaid shipping label generated automatically when a repair ticket is created.

5. Ticketing System

All IT requests, whether hardware, software, network, or account-related, should be logged through the helpdesk portal at help.northfieldanalytics.example rather than by email, so requests can be tracked and prioritized correctly. Each ticket is assigned a priority level: Critical (system down, response within 1 hour), High (major disruption, response within 4 hours), Medium (response within 1 business day), and Low (response within 3 business days). You can check the status of your ticket at any time by logging into the portal and viewing 'My Tickets'.

6. Security Guidelines

6.1 Phishing and Suspicious Emails

Employees should never click links or open attachments from unknown senders. Suspicious emails can be reported using the 'Report Phishing' button in Outlook, which forwards the email directly to the security team for analysis. Do not forward suspicious emails to colleagues.

6.2 Device Security

Company laptops must have full-disk encryption enabled, which is configured automatically during setup by IT. Devices must be locked whenever unattended, and screens should auto-lock after 5 minutes of inactivity. Personal USB drives may not be connected to company devices without prior approval from the security team, as this is disabled by default at the endpoint policy level.

6.3 Data Handling

Client data must only be stored in approved company systems such as the corporate file share or the CRM; it must never be copied to personal cloud storage, personal email, or personal devices. Any suspected data breach or lost device containing company data must be reported to the security team within 1 hour of discovery.

7. Contact

For all IT questions or requests, open a ticket at help.northfieldanalytics.example or email itsupport@northfieldanalytics.example. For urgent security incidents outside business hours, call the 24/7 security hotline listed on the internal emergency contacts page.